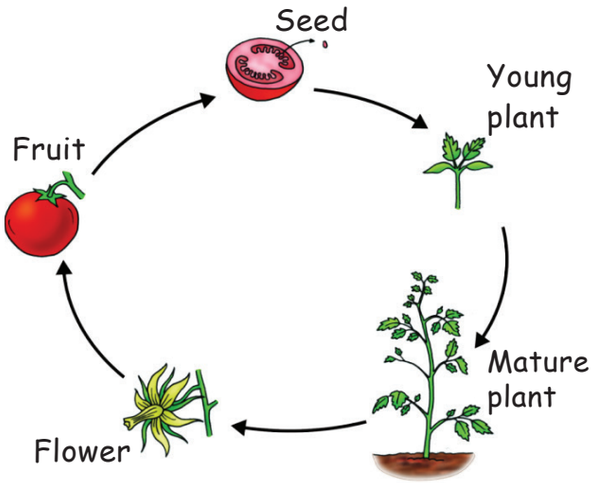


II. Life Cycle of a Flowering Plant

The major stages of the flowering plants are: germination of seed, growth, flowering, re-production (pollination), seed formation and seed spreading. Every seed has minute plant called embryo. Under favourable conditions like sunlight, water and soil, embryo grows into a new plant. This new plant bears fruits with seeds and multiplies. This cycle continues forming the life cycle of flowering plants.

1 Dispersal of Seeds

Spreading of seeds from one place to another with the help of agents like air, water, animals and birds is known as dispersal of seeds. A single plant produces a large number of seeds. If all these seeds fall directly below the parent plant, the seedlings would have to compete for space, water, oxygen, minerals and sun light. When the seedlings are grouped together in one place, they can easily be destroyed by grazing animals. So, by nature the seeds and fruits of plants are distributed far and wide through various agencies.



❖ Dispersal by Wind (Anemochory)

The seeds which are smaller, lighter and tiny float in air over long distance. Some of them proceed with hairs and membranous wing like structures and so they are carried away easily. E.g. Cotton seed, Drumstick.



❖ Dispersal by Water (Hydrochory)

Fruits which are dispersed by water have outer coats modified to enable them to float. The mesocarp (middle layer) of coconut is fibrous and is easily carried away by water. They reach different places and grow into a new plant. E.g. Lotus, Coconut.



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